



THE BOOKE OF Esther.

CHAP. I.

1 Ahasuerus maketh royall feasts. 10 Vasthi, sent for, refuseth to come. 13 Ahasuerus, by the counsell of Memucan, maketh the decree of mens souerainie.

NOW it came to passe in the dayes of Ahasuerus, (this is Ahasuerus which reigned from India, even vnto Ethiopia, ouer an hundred, and tenen and twentie prouinces.)

2 That in those dayes, when the King Ahasuerus sat on the throne of his kingdome, which was in Shushan the palace :

3 In the third yere of his reigne, he made a feast vnto all his Princes, and his seruants, the power of Persia and Media, the Nobles and Princes of the prouinces being before him.

4 When he shewed the riches of his glorious kingdome, and the honour of his excellent maiestie, many dayes, even an hundred and fourescore dayes.

5 And when these dayes were expired, the king made a feast vnto all the people that were † present in Shushan the palace, both vnto great and small, seven dayes, in the court of the garden of the kings palace,

6 Where were white, greene and ‖ blew hangings, fastened with cords of fine linnen, and purple, to siluer rings, and pillars of marble: the beds were of gold and siluer, vpon a pauement of ‖ red, and blew, and white, and blacke marble.

7 And they gaue them drinke in vessels of gold, (the vessels being diuers one from another) and † royall wine in

abundance, according to the † state of the king.

8 And the drinking was according to the law, none did compell: for the king had appoynted to all the officers of his house, that they should doe according to euery mans pleasure.

9 Also Vasthi the Queene made a feast for the women, in the royall house which belonged to king Ahasuerus.

10 ¶ On the seuenth day, when the heart of the King was merry with wine, he commanded Methuman, Biztha, Harbona, Bigtha, and Abagtha, Zethar, and Cartas, the seven ‖ chamberlens that serued in the presence of Ahasuerus the king,

11 To bring Vasthi the Queene before the king, with the Crowne royall, to shew the people, and the Princes her beautie: for she was † faire to looke on.

12 But the Queene Vasthi refused to come at the Kings commandement † by his chamberlens: therefore was the King very wroth, and his anger burned in him.

13 ¶ Then the king saide to the wise men, which knew the times (for so was the Kings maner towards all that knew law, and iudgement :

14 And the next vnto him, was Carshena, Shethar, Admatha, Tarshis, Meres, Martena, and Memucan, the seven * Princes of Persia, and Media, which saw the Kings face, and which sat the first in the kingdome.)

15 † What shall wee doe vnto the Queene Vasthi, according to law, because she hath not performed the commandement of the king Ahasuerus, by the chamberlens :

16 And Memucan answered before the king and the Princes: Vasthi the Queene hath not done wrong to the king onely, but also to all the Princes, and to all the people that are in all the

† Heb. according to the
law of the
king.

‖ Or. Eunuchs.

† Heb. good
of com-
mence.

† Heb.
which was
in the hand
of his Eunuchs.

* Ezra 7.14.

† Heb. what
to doe?

† Heb.
found.

‖ Or. violet.

‖ Or. of por-
phyre, and
marble, and
alabaster,
and stone of
blew colour.
† Heb. wine
of the king-
dome.